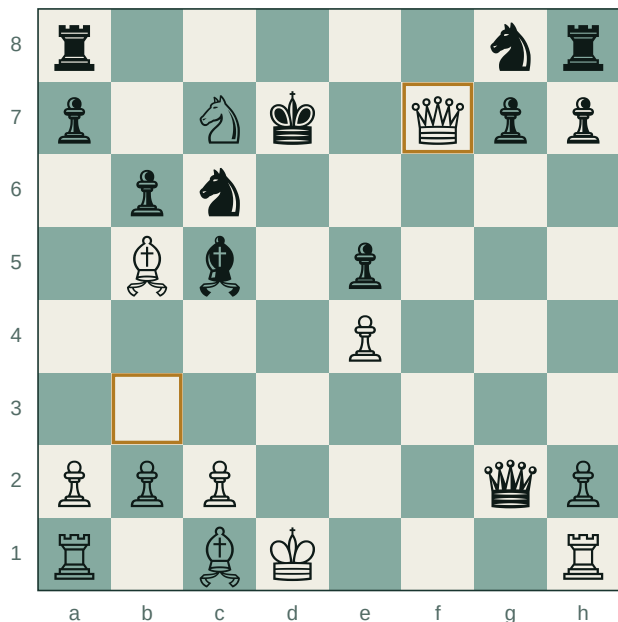


Active defensive resources: Black, move 13

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Qxf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Ne7 14. Qf1 Qxf1+

13...Ne7 The knight moves from g8 to e7. Recorded reply: **14.Qf1**.

14...Qxf1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From f1 it attacks king on d1, rook on h1 and bishop on b5.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on d1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f7 and knight on c7. Check for tactical protection.